

New Features Guide

Three New Features Added!

1. **RSS Feed** - Subscribe functionality
 2. **Social Sharing** - Share buttons on every post
 3. **Admin Dashboard** - Easy content management
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1 RSS Feed

What It Does

- Auto-generates an RSS feed at `/feed.xml`
- Includes latest 20 published posts
- Standard RSS 2.0 format
- Works with all RSS readers

How to Use

For Readers: - Visit: `http://localhost:3000/feed.xml` - Add to your RSS reader (Feedly, Inoreader, etc.) - RSS link is in the header navigation

For You: - Nothing to do! It's automatic - Updates whenever you publish a post - Includes title, excerpt, link, and publish date

Testing

View the feed

```
curl http://localhost:3000/feed.xml
```

Or open in browser

```
open http://localhost:3000/feed.xml
```

For Production

Update your `.env` to set the correct URL:

```
FRONTEND_URL=https://yourblog.com
```

2 Social Sharing Buttons

What It Does

- Share buttons on every blog post
- Platforms: Twitter/X, Facebook, LinkedIn, Reddit, Email
- Copy link button with visual feedback

- Open Graph meta tags for rich previews
- Twitter Card support

Features

Share Buttons: - Twitter/X - Share with tweet - Facebook - Share to timeline - LinkedIn - Share to feed - Reddit - Submit to subreddit - Email - Send via email - Copy Link - One-click copy

Meta Tags: - Post title, description, image - Proper Open Graph tags - Twitter Card with large image - SEO optimized

Where to Find

- Bottom of every blog post
- Just above “Back to all posts” link

Customization

Edit `frontend/components/ShareButtons.tsx` to: - Change button colors - Add/remove platforms - Customize styling - Add analytics tracking

3 Admin Dashboard

What It Does

- Visual interface for managing posts
- No more curl commands!
- Create, edit, view posts
- See analytics at a glance
- Draft/publish workflow

How to Access

URL: `http://localhost:3001/admin`

Note: Currently no authentication - anyone can access! (Authentication coming in next update)

Dashboard Features

Stats Overview: - Total Posts - Published Posts - Draft Posts - Total Views

Recent Posts Table: - Post title and slug - Status badge (draft/published) - View count - Creation date - Quick actions (Edit/View)

Creating a New Post

1. **Go to Admin Panel**

`http://localhost:3001/admin`

2. **Click “Create New Post”** or go to `/admin/posts/new`

3. **Fill in the Form:**

- **Title** - Auto-generates slug
- **Slug** - URL-friendly identifier
- **Excerpt** - Short description (optional)
- **Featured Image** - URL to image (optional)
- **Content** - Full post in Markdown

4. **Toggle Preview** to see how it looks

5. **Save Draft** or **Publish** immediately

Form Features

Auto-slug Generation: - Type a title - Slug is automatically created - Example: “Hello World” → “hello-world” - Can be edited manually

Markdown Editor: - Full Markdown support - Syntax highlighting - Live preview mode - 20 rows of space

Image Preview: - Paste image URL - See preview immediately - Validates image loads

Draft Workflow: - Save as draft first - Review and edit - Publish when ready

Markdown Guide

`# Heading 1`

`## Heading 2`

`### Heading 3`

`**Bold text**`

`*Italic text*`

`- Bullet point`

`- Another point`

`1. Numbered list`

`2. Second item`

`[Link text](https://example.com)`

`![Image alt](https://example.com/image.jpg)`

> Blockquote

``inline code``

````code`

`Code block`

### ### Managing Posts

#### **\*\*View All Posts:\*\***

- Go to `/admin/posts``
- See all posts in a table
- Filter by status (coming soon)
- Search posts (coming soon)

#### **\*\*Edit Post:\*\***

- Click "Edit" in the table
- Same form as create
- Changes saved immediately

#### **\*\*View Published Post:\*\***

- Click "View" to see live post
- Opens in new tab

#### **\*\*Delete Post:\*\***

- Currently via API only
- UI delete button coming soon

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## ## Quick Start Guide

### ### 1. Start the Backend

````bash`

`cd backend`

`# Make sure .env has FRONTEND_URL=http://localhost:3001`

`cargo run`

2. Start the Frontend

`cd frontend`

`npm run dev`

3. Create Your First Post

Option A: Using Admin Dashboard (Recommended) 1. Visit `http://localhost:3001/admin` 2. Click “Create New Post” 3. Fill in the form 4. Click “Publish”

Option B: Using curl (Old Way)

```
curl -X POST http://localhost:3000/api/posts \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{
    "title": "My First Post",
    "slug": "my-first-post",
    "content": "# Hello World\n\nThis is my first post!",
    "status": "published"
  }'
```

4. View Your Post

1. Go to `http://localhost:3001`
2. See your post in the grid
3. Click to read
4. See share buttons at the bottom

5. Subscribe to RSS

1. Visit `http://localhost:3000/feed.xml`
2. Copy URL
3. Add to RSS reader
4. Get notified of new posts

Customization

Change Blog Title/Description

Edit `frontend/app/layout.tsx`:

```
export const metadata: Metadata = {
  title: 'My Awesome Blog',
  description: 'Your custom description here',
}
```

RSS Feed Title

Edit `backend/src/rss.rs`:

```
<title>My Awesome Blog</title>
<description>Your description</description>
```

Share Button Colors

Edit frontend/components/ShareButtons.tsx:

```
// Twitter button
className="bg-black hover:bg-gray-800"

// Change to:
className="bg-blue-500 hover:bg-blue-600"
```

Admin Dashboard Colors

Edit frontend/app/admin/layout.tsx:

```
// Sidebar
className="bg-gray-900"

// Change to:
className="bg-blue-900"
```

Tips & Best Practices

Writing Posts

1. **Use Markdown** - It's simple and powerful
2. **Add Featured Images** - Posts with images get more clicks
3. **Write Good Excerpts** - Shows up in RSS and social shares
4. **Use Clear Slugs** - Good for SEO

SEO Optimization

1. **Titles** - Keep under 60 characters
2. **Excerpts** - 150-160 characters ideal
3. **Images** - Use descriptive alt text
4. **Slugs** - Use keywords, keep short

Social Sharing

1. **Featured Image** - Use 1200x630px for best results
 2. **Excerpt** - This becomes the social description
 3. **Title** - Keep punchy and interesting
-

Security Notes

IMPORTANT: The admin dashboard currently has NO authentication!

Before deploying to production: 1. Add authentication (JWT or session-based) 2. Protect /admin routes 3. Add role-based access control 4. Implement rate limiting

I can build authentication next if you want!

Troubleshooting

RSS Feed Shows “localhost”

Fix: Update FRONTEND_URL in backend/.env

FRONTEND_URL=https://yourdomain.com

Share Buttons Not Working

Check: Make sure JavaScript is enabled **Fix:** Share buttons require client-side JavaScript

Can’t Create Posts in Admin

Check: 1. Backend is running (cargo run) 2. Frontend can reach backend 3. Check browser console for errors

Images Not Showing

Check: 1. Image URL is valid and accessible 2. CORS allows the image domain 3. Try opening URL directly in browser

What’s Next?

Want me to add: - **Authentication** - Secure the admin panel - **Search** - Find posts quickly - **Image Upload** - No more URL pasting - **Rich Editor** - WYSIWYG instead of Markdown - **Newsletter** - Email subscribers - **Comments** - Reader engagement

Just let me know which feature you want next!

API Reference

New Endpoints

RSS Feed:

GET /feed.xml

Returns: XML RSS feed

Existing Endpoints

GET	/api/posts	- List posts
GET	/api/posts/by-slug/{slug}	- Get post
POST	/api/posts	- Create post
PUT	/api/posts/{id}	- Update post
DELETE	/api/posts/{id}	- Delete post

Enjoy your new features!

Need help? Check the main README or ask for assistance!